



Figure 7: The Time Slider icon in the Nautilus toolbar



Figure 8: Tracker Search Tool

One of the places that the snapshot feature of ZFS is on display is the new Time Slider.

What in the world is a Time Slider?

The Time Slider provides a way to set up automatic backups of your data on the same disk, enabling you to browse and restore older versions of files using GNOME's Nautilus file browser. Anyone who has ever accidentally deleted or overwritten an important file will appreciate the time and effort saved by being able to walk back in time and pick up an older version of the file without even leaving the file browser!

Time Slider is disabled by default. You can enable it via *System*→*Administration*→*Time Slider Setup*. To browse your backups, open the file manager, navigate to the directory you are interested in and click the icon with a clock (Figure 7) in the Nautilus toolbar ("Browse the current location snapshot history"), and use the slider that is displayed to go back in time to a view of the directory from the past. To restore an item, right-click on it and choose 'Restore to Desktop'.

Can't remember where a file is... now what?

Tracker is a desktop search tool used to locate data from the system, including text documents, music, video/image files and e-mails. It indexes the filesystem in real time and automatically keeps its metadata up to date.

Tracker is not enabled by default. To enable it, go to *System*→*Preferences*→*Sessions* and enable the 'Tracker' and 'Tracker Applet' start-up programs. You might also want the tracker to index your home directory. To enable this and other configuration tweaks, start up a terminal window and run the 'tracker-preferences' command.

You can launch the tracker search window by clicking the magnifying glass icon in the toolbar.

Network auto-magic

Several enhancements have been made to the simplified network management infrastructure (NWAM) in OpenSolaris 2008.11. This, coupled with a vastly improved set of wireless drivers supporting WPA, ensures that OpenSolaris 2008.11 gets closer to, "it just works!"

Right-click on the network manager icon in the system tray to switch between wired and wireless networks, and to choose from among the list of available wireless options.

What else?

A new Print Manager is included in the release, which provides support for the management of printers, auto-detection of USB printers, etc. CUPS support is planned for a future release.

OpenSolaris 2008.11 includes suspend to RAM support for a limited set of laptops from Toshiba (Tecra M8, Tecra M9, Tecra M10, Tecra A9, Satellite A205, Portege R500), Lenovo (64608VU, 889703U) and Dell (Latitude D630, Precision M4300), apart from all Sun Ultra 20, Ultra 24 and Ultra 40 workstations.

Finally, a lot of utilities that people moving from Linux expect to find are available by default, though there are OpenSolaris alternatives available, which are preferable in most cases. For example, *sudo*, *top* and *sllocate* are installed by default—the OpenSolaris alternatives being *pfexec*, *prstat* and *tracker-search*, respectively.

If you have any issues installing or using the live CD, head over to the release notes wiki at tinyurl.com/lfy-openSolaris-release-notes and check if the problem has already been reported. If not, please add the details in the 'Discussion' tab on the wiki page. Also, you are welcome to join the Bangalore OpenSolaris User Group at openSolaris.org/os/project/bosug where you can discuss these and related issues. 

References

- OpenSolaris 2008.11 Release Notes Wiki: tinyurl.com/lfy-openSolaris-release-notes
- What's New in OpenSolaris 2008.11: www.openSolaris.com/team/features/whats-new/2008.11
- Upgrading from OpenSolaris 2008.05 to 2008.11: tinyurl.com/openSolaris-upgrade-2008.11
- Troubleshooting OpenSolaris logins: tinyurl.com/openSolaris-troubleshoot-login
- Sun Web Stack: tinyurl.com/sun-web-stack
- Bangalore OpenSolaris User Group: openSolaris.org/os/project/bosug

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